

Throneberry sure he'll stay

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ers know it, so naturally I see a lot of bad pitches.

"I have been able to control it a bit lately," Marv says. "I walked 111 times last year at Denver and that was a new high for me. That is the one thing I have to work on this spring and when I get a chance in exhibition games, I won't swing at the bad ones."

Ralph Houk, who managed Thorneberry, agrees with Marv's self analysis. "At first you would have thought it was against the law for him to walk. He would get a 3-2 count, then swing at anything they threw. Just think what he would have hit without those strikeouts and that first horrible month each year."

Last season when Thorneberry reported to camp he had a bad arm and couldn't throw. That, of course, doomed him to another year in the minors but this time he is hale, hearty and determined. As is to punctuate his challenge, Marv hit one over the far away right field fence on his first appearance in batting practice.

Andy Cohen, whose Indianapolis pitchers had to face Thornberry last year, gave this report: "Thorneberry kills you. Either he'll hit a couple early in the game and put you so far behind you never catch up, or you strike him out a couple of times, then he kills you with a homer in the ninth. I'm glad he's on my side now."